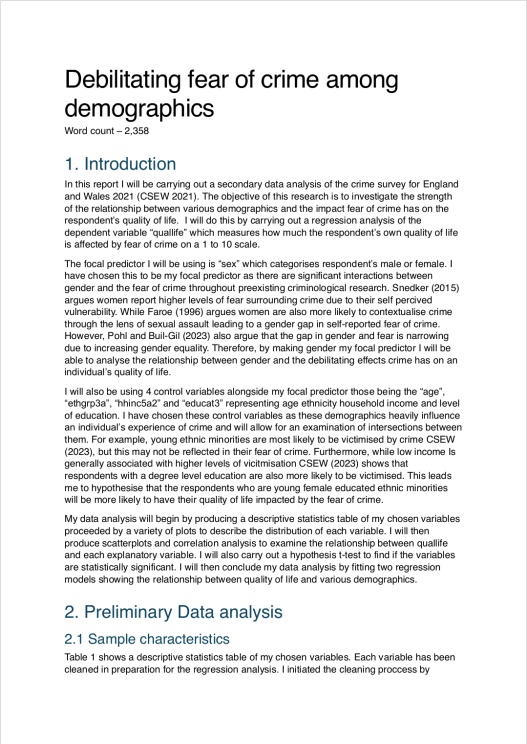
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Debilitating fear of crime among demographics

Word count – 2,358

1. Introduction

In this report I will be carrying out a secondary data analysis of the crime survey for England and Wales 2021 (CSEW 2021). The objective of this research is to investigate the strength of the relationship between various demographics and the impact fear of crime has on the respondent's quality of life. I will do this by carrying out a regression analysis of the dependent variable "quallife" which measures how much the respondent's own quality of life is affected by fear of crime on a 1 to 10 scale.

The focal predictor I will be using is "sex" which categorises respondent's male or female. I have chosen this to be my focal predictor as there are significant interactions between gender and the fear of crime throughout preexisting criminological research. Snedker (2015) argues women report higher levels of fear surrounding crime due to their self perceived vulnerability. While Farce (1996) argues women are also more likely to contextualise crime through the lens of sexual assault leading to a gender gap in self-reported fear of crime. However, Pohl and Buil-Gil (2023) also argue that the gap in gender and fear is narrowing due to increasing gender equality. Therefore, by making gender my focal predictor I will be able to analyse the relationship between gender and the debilitating effects crime has on an individual's quality of life.

I will also be using 4 control variables alongside my focal predictor those being the "age", "ethgrp3a", "hhinc5a2" and "educat3" representing age ethnicity household income and level of education. I have chosen these control variables as these demographics heavily influence an individual's experience of crime and will allow for an examination of intersections between them. For example, young ethnic minorities are most likely to be victimised by crime CSEW (2023), but this may not be reflected in their fear of crime. Furthermore, while low income is generally associated with higher levels of victimisation CSEW (2023) shows that respondents with a degree level education are also more likely to be victimised. This leads me to hypothesise that the respondents who are young female educated ethnic minorities will be more likely to have their quality of life impacted by the fear of crime.

My data analysis will begin by producing a descriptive statistics table of my chosen variables proceeded by a variety of plots to describe the distribution of each variable. I will then produce scatterplots and correlation analysis to examine the relationship between quallife and each explanatory variable. I will also carry out a hypothesis t-test to find if the variables are statistically significant. I will then conclude my data analysis by fitting two regression models showing the relationship between quality of life and various demographics.

2. Preliminary Data analysis

2.1 Sample characteristics

Table 1 shows a descriptive statistics table of my chosen variables. Each variable has been cleaned in preparation for the regression analysis. I initiated the cleaning proccess by

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